# New College Courses: Spring 2027




# New College Office: Lloyd 201

## Introduction:

This course booklet provides information about New College classes for Spring 2027. All students are invited to take New College courses to satisfy University of Alabama core requirements or pursue subjects they are passionate about. **We welcome students from other departments and disciplines** to register for New College classes. **Unless specifically noted, there are no prerequisites for these courses**.

This list is divided into three sections: (1) courses required of majors in New College, (2) courses that fulfill New College seminar requirements, and (3) other courses connected to New College. To the right of course titles, students will find two types of information in parentheses: UA core designations (if applicable: FA, HU, L, N, SB, W) and New College seminar designations (if applicable: CC, ESC, SPSC). This second group of designations is for use by New College students only.

**New College Seminar Requirements:** New College students must take one seminar in each of the areas listed below and at least five seminars overall. Students are required to complete at least two lower-division seminars (from different thematic designations) and two upper-division seminars (from any designation, provided that all three themes are represented).

**NOTE:** New College students enrolled in the 2026-2027 academic catalog are required to take NEW 200: Idea Lab as one of their five seminars. Please consult your advisor for details.

## New College Seminar Thematic Designations:

**Creativity and Culture (CC):** These seminars explore the world of the mind, specifically the realms of human thought and expressive practice. They interrogate the beliefs, values, and dispositions that comprise culture, and focus on essential questions about what it means to be human. Seminars focus on such issues as the urge to create and to appreciate creativity and perspectives on class, gender, race, and place.

**Environment, Sustainability, and Conservation (ESC):** These seminars explore the physical world, especially relations among elements of the natural world, and focus on relationships between humans and their environment. Of special interest is the impact humans have on the environment, including issues of climate change, resource depletion, and pollution. Besides identifying problems, seminars also interrogate pathways that avoid environmental destruction by promoting sustainability and conservation.

**Social Problems and Social Change (SPSC):** These seminars explore the social world, the problems societies confront, and the ways human groups cause and respond to social change. Specific areas of interest include: the basis for cooperation and conflict within and between societies; extremes of human destructiveness such as genocide and ethnic conflict; historical dimensions or antecedents of contemporary problems; and civic engagement, social responsibility, and other means of promoting healthy communities.

## Other Opportunities in New College:

**Minors:** In addition to serving students who wish to self-design a major or "depth study," New College also houses various minors. If you are interested in proposing a **Student-designed Minor** or pursuing a minor in **Civic Engagement and Leadership** or **Natural Resource Management**, please contact Dr. Andrew Dewar (adewar@ua.edu). For information on the minor in **Interdisciplinary Environmental Studies**, contact Dr. Michael Steinberg (mksteinberg@ua.edu).

**Independent Study or Internship:** If you would like to design and receive credit for an independent study or internship, you must see Prof. John Miller (mille031@ua.edu) prior to the start of any independent work.

## Reminders for New College Students:

**Pre-Advising Checklist:** All New College students should go to the "Resources for Students" section of the New College webpage to download and complete the Pre-Advising Checklist before advising each semester (https://newcollege.ua.edu/resources). Students in the 2026-2027 academic catalog should consult their advisor regarding requirements.

**Third Year Review:** All juniors are responsible for initiating conversation with their advisor about the Third Year Review. Completion of the Third Year Review is mandatory for graduation with the Interdisciplinary Studies degree and must be completed to be eligible to enroll in NEW 495: Capstone Seminar and Senior Project. It should be completed in the year prior to graduation.

# COURSE LISTINGS FOR SPRING 2027

## REQUIRED COURSES

**NEW 100-001: Intro Interdisciplinary and Integrative Studies**

**NOTE: This course is no longer being offered.** Students required to take NEW 100 to fulfill their major in Interdisciplinary Studies are encouraged to enroll in NEW 200 instead and should consult their advisor regarding this requirement. This course is not required for students enrolled in the 2026-2027 academic catalog.

**NEW 200-001: Idea Lab**
**Vincent Willis**
**TR 11:00am - 12:15am, LY 306**
**3 Hours**

**NOTE:** Beginning with the 2025-2026 catalog, all New College students are required to take NEW 200, but regardless of requirements, the seminar is open to all students of *any* catalog year. NEW 200 will fulfill one of the five seminars required for the Interdisciplinary Studies major in New College. Please consult your advisor for details.

Do you have a burning question or big idea you would like to develop or answer through research? Idea Lab is an interdisciplinary research incubator that challenges and empowers students to engage in a collaborative, semester-long project that asks questions and finds answers. Learn the nuts and bolts of creating and completing a collaborative multi-layered interdisciplinary research project-skills applicable in any field. Idea Lab is designed as a guided process of brainstorming, team building, interdisciplinary project design and management. You will be introduced to a range of multi-disciplinary tools (e.g., ethnography and qualitative research, quantitative data collection, archival/historical research, aesthetic/arts research) to help you accomplish your team's research goals and learn best practices for interdisciplinary research.

**NEW495-001: Capstone Seminar & Senior Project (BY PERMISSION) (doesn't count as NC seminar)**
**Julia Cherry**
**T 3:30pm - 5:20pm, LY 202**
**2 Hours**

The senior project is **required of all New College Interdisciplinary Studies majors in their senior year**. It gives students the opportunity to put into practice interdisciplinary and integrative methods of scholarship while refining knowledge of their depth study area. Projects must result in a piece of interdisciplinary writing and a twenty-minute oral presentation at our New College Senior Research Symposium.

**NOTE:** Students planning to attend graduate or professional schools (e.g., Master's, Law School, Medical School) are **strongly encouraged** to take NEW 495 in the Fall semester. This will allow you to use the senior project as part of your applications. **ONLY** students who have completed the Third Year Review may enroll in New 495.

# NEW COLLEGE SEMINARS

**NEW 200-001: Idea Lab**
**Vincent Willis**
**TR 11:00am - 12:15pm, LY 306**
**3 Hours**

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**NEW 212: Creativity (FA/HU) (CC)**

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|---|---|---|---|
| **-001: John Miller** | **MW 10am - 11:50am** | **LY 202** | **4 Hours** |
| **-002: Amy Pirkle** | **MW 12:00pm - 1:50pm** | **LY 202** | **4 Hours** |
| **-003: Holland Hopson** | **TR 2:00pm - 3:50pm** | **LY 306** | **4 Hours** |

This interdisciplinary seminar uses creativity as an organizing principle. Human culture and consciousness are explored through reading, writing, the arts, projects, studios, and discussion.

**NEW 213-001: Honors Creativity (FA/HU/UH) (CC)**
**John Miller**
**MW 10:00am - 11:50am, LY 202**
**4 Hours**

Registration requires enrollment in UA Honors College. This interdisciplinary seminar uses creativity as an organizing principle. Human culture and consciousness are explored through reading, writing, the arts, projects, studios, and discussion. As an Honors College approved New College seminar, this course can be counted both toward New College seminar requirements and Honors College credit hour requirements.

**NEW 215-001: Perspectives on Environmental Literature (HU) (ESC)**
**Michael Steinberg**
**TR 11:00am - 12:50am, LY 215**
**4 Hours**

Considers perspectives on Environmental Studies within the Humanities by examining key texts of environmental literature.

**NEW 226: Organic Farming (ESC)**
**Leah Connell**
**R 9:00am - 10:50am, LY 306**
**R 3:00pm - 4:50pm, Jeremiah's Garden**
**4 Hours**

In this course, we will study and practice organic farming. Students will learn and enact the basics of how to grow food organically, with an emphasis on healthy soil, composting, covering crops, seed starting and transplanting, pest control, etc. At the same time, we will address fundamental questions and issues behind the organic model: Why do it? What are the problems with industrial agriculture? And how does it shape the way we eat and think about food? How does it influence our relationship to the land and to our communities? How does our food production fit into an analysis of current environmental problems and solutions? What does organic even mean?

Each week, students will spend time in the classroom and time in the "field" at Jeremiah's Garden, a 1-acre farm site and community food organization across the street from Holy Spirit Catholic Church. Students will be evaluated on their active participation, weekly writing assignments, and semester-long research and/or community-based project. **This course requires students to provide their own transportation to the field site and to engage in moderate physical activity.**

**NEW 237-001: Social Problems and Social Change (SB) (SPSC)**
**Albena Dzhurova**
**TR 2:00pm-3:50pm, LY215**
**4 Hours**

This seminar explores significant social problems in contemporary society and the complex ways in which social change occurs. Students investigate and seek solutions for current social problems. **This course has a 12-hour service-learning component.**

**NEW 238-001 Honors: Social Problems and Social Change (SB/UH) (SPSC)**
**Albena Dzhurova**
**TR 2:00pm - 3:50pm, LY 215**
**4 Hours**

Registration requires enrollment in UA Honors College. This honors seminar explores significant social problems in contemporary society and the complex ways in which social change occurs. Students investigate and seek solutions to current social problems. **This course has a service-learning component that may involve 12 service-learning hours outside of class time.**

**NEW 243: Interdisciplinary Sciences (N) (ESC)**

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| **-001: Leah Connell** | **M 1:00pm - 4:50pm** | **MSB 1010** | **4 Hours** |
| **-002: Emily Elliott** | **T 12:30pm - 4:20pm** | **MSB 1010** | **4 Hours** |
| **-003: Amanda Brown** | **W 1:00pm - 4:50pm** | **MSB 1010** | **4 Hours** |
| **-004: Emily Elliott** | **R 12:30pm - 4:20pm** | **MSB 1010** | **4 Hours** |

This seminar demonstrates how laboratory and field research play an essential role in the understanding and advancement of science. Multidisciplinary experiments and exercises are performed in an effort to increase scientific literacy and to provide knowledge for addressing the scientific basis of real-world problems. Examples of assignments include papers, laboratory write-ups, student presentations, and discussions of scientific topics. Readings are taken from a variety of sources providing fundamental scientific knowledge on topics related to laboratory exercises. **This is a field-based class that involves frequent outdoor excursions and hands-on activities.** This 4.0 credit hour seminar meets the University's Natural Sciences (N) core requirement. For New College students, it also counts as an Environment, Sustainability, and Conservation (ESC) seminar. There are no prerequisites.

**NEW 335-001: Everyday Wildlife in Alabama (ESC)**
**Wayne Ford**
**M 2:00pm - 4:50pm, LY 319**
**3 Hours**

Everyday Wildlife in Alabama will cover management practices on how to maximize wildlife in woodlands or in a neighborhood. It will cover practices on how to improve the habitat to increase the wildlife population as well as practices on wildlife predator control for wildlife critters who have become invasive in various areas. Some topics that will be discussed will include backyard wildlife management, how to manage a recreational fishpond, wildlife identification, compass and pacing, the use of aerial photography in managing wildlife, and how to prepare wildlife food plots. **Much of this course will include "hands-on" outdoor field trips.**

**NEW 390-001: Special Topics: *SLANT* (SPSC)**
**Catherine Roach**
**F 12:00pm - 2:50pm, New College Conference Room**
**3 Hours**

*Are you interested in art that connects with community, identity, or social change?*
*Want to integrate artmaking into your research?*
*Or incorporate work from academic disciplines into your art practice?*

Dr. Catherine Roach is recruiting students to participate in *SLANT*: The New College Arts Research Lab in Spring 2027. *SLANT* stands for "*S*tudying *L*iberation through *A*rt *Ne*T*w*orks." The *SLANT* Lab launched in early 2026 with students working on projects of their own design in arts-integrated research and creative activity. Students wrote poetry, romance fiction, short stories, children's books, and comic books. They designed fiber arts, analyzed music lyrics, created photography collage, made paintings, and more. Through these varied arts media, we studied issues of identity, kinship, public memory, community formation, discrimination, resilience, and the meaning of life. Dr. Roach shared her book-in-progress on a famous statue of American art history (two versions held at UA) and the relationship between art and social change.

Building on the successful launch of the *SLANT* Lab, the project continues as a Special Topics seminar in Spring 2027. If you're interested in a collaborative and supportive workshop space to think about issues of art, join the *SLANT* Lab. Email Dr. Roach at croach@ua.edu or pop into her office at Lloyd 218 for more information.

**NEW 415-001: Gender, Sexuality, & Pop Culture (W) (SPSC/CC)**
**Catherine Roach**
**W 2:00pm - 4:50pm, LY 319**
**3 Hours**

What constitutes "femininity" and "masculinity" in 21st century America? How have gender roles changed? Is gender performance? What are the cultural expectations around sexuality, and how is it influenced and policed in society? Includes professor's current case research in this field. Writing proficiency within this discipline is required for a passing grade in this course.

**NEW 419-001: Arts Entrepreneurship**
**Holland Hopson**
**TR 9:30am-10:45am, LY 202**
**3 Hours**

This course is an exploration of Arts Entrepreneurship in a seminar format. Our class goal is to gain a deeper understanding of the creative process as applied to entrepreneurial activity, with a focus on arts-based endeavors. Students will learn essential concepts and skills to pursue successful careers in the arts. Students will study a variety of creative, entrepreneurial approaches within the context of the Lean Startup methodology. Throughout the course students will practice what they learn by developing their own entrepreneurial micro-ventures.

**NEW 421-001: Youth Culture**
**Barbara Brickman**
**MW 1:00pm-2:15pm, LY 306**
**3 Hours**

This seminar provides an introduction to historical accounts of and psychological and sociological examinations of youth, as well as popular representations, in order to critique the nature and significance of youth cultures. One's youth, or adolescence, is a time of constructing a personal identity, in other words solidifying one's beliefs, values, and selfhood. Yet, also, as a collective, the choices made by youth have incredible influence on American culture at large, and youth activism has long forged change around the globe. Young people are molded by but also influence the changes in mass media, reliance on new technologies, and political debates about class, race, and sexuality, amongst others. Writing proficiency is required for a passing grade in this course. A student who does not write with the skill normally required of an upper-division student will not earn a passing grade, no matter how well the student performs in other areas of the course.

**NEW 436-001: Public Leadership (W) (SPSC)**
**John Miller**
**MW 2:00pm - 3:50pm, LY 202**
**4 Hours**

This seminar helps students develop the understanding and skills necessary for the practice of public leadership. The course emphasizes framing public issues for discussion and leading the decision making necessary to set the direction of public policy. Writing proficiency is required for a passing grade in this course. A student who does not write with the skill normally required of an upper-division student will not earn a passing grade, no matter how well the student performs in other areas of the course.

**NEW 472-001: Social Change**
**Kim Colburn**
**MW 1:00pm-2:50pm, LY 215**
**4 Hours**

This seminar is concerned with the process and analysis of social change. In this seminar, students study the Holocaust, attempting to understand it as an intense and unparalleled human experience. The causes, events, outcomes, and implications are researched through books, films, interviews, tapes, and discussions. Writing proficiency is required for a passing grade in this course. A student who does not write with the skill normally required of an upper-division student will not earn a passing grade, no matter how well the student performs in other areas of the course.

**NEW 490-001: Special Topics: Political Ecology (SPSC)**
**Reed Byg**
**TR 12:30pm - 1:45pm, LY 319**
**4 Hours**

This course examines key themes in Political Ecology (PE), an interdisciplinary field that studies the role of structural forces and power relations in environmental change. Political Ecology gives close attention to matters of justice, power, and inequality in shaping the places and spaces in which we live, work, and play. In paying attention to question of knowledge creation and contested human-nature interactions, political ecology works to promote environmental well-being, political change, and social good amidst intersecting and entwined crises of the modern world. While no course is comprehensive in its treatment of a given field, this course surveys a wide range of scholarships and cases to provide students with an understanding of PE's dynamic and multi-faceted approach to modern socio-environmental issues. Case studies will include (but are not limited to) the following: water quality and access, food systems, conservation/extinction, and land degradation.

# NON-SEMINAR COURSES

## The following courses *do not fulfill* New College seminar requirements.

**FA 200: Introduction to Fine Arts (FA) (does not count as NC seminar)**
**-001: Andrew Dewar ONLINE 3 Hours**
**-002: Karen Brummand TR 12:30pm -1:45pm LY 226 3 Hours**

An introduction to the fine arts, drawing especially on campus and community cultural events. This course is usually open to freshmen.

**NEW 101-001: Chart Your Own Path (First-year Compass) (does not count as NC seminar)**
**Julia Cherry**
**T 3:30pm - 4:20pm, LY 202**
**1 Hour**

A first-year compass course familiarizing students with university requirements and resources. This course also covers integrative learning across the liberal arts to maximize opportunities in undergraduate programs. Encouraged for undecided students and those considering an Interdisciplinary Studies major through New College.

**NEW 145-001: Technology and Society**
**Barbara Brickman**
**MW 10:00am- 11:15am, LY 319**
**3 Hours**

Across the globe today, there is a growing interdependence between human beings and our advanced digital, computing, biotech, robotics, and artificial intelligence technologies. Many are debating what impact this increasingly close relationship and intertwining is having on human interpersonal relationships and behavior, the future of work and employment, and our social and political structures and institutions. This course engages these debates about recent advanced technologies to consider how they have and continue to impact both human behavior and social structures, in the United States and around the world. It provides an overview of recent technological advancements in computing, artificial intelligence, autonomous systems, biotechnology, robotics, and immersive systems and the interdisciplinary examinations of these advances from sociological, psychological, ethical, philosophical, and political perspectives. Students will gain the knowledge, critical thinking skills, and cultural competence to evaluate and analyze for themselves the issues surrounding the integral adoption of these advanced technologies in contemporary society.

**NEW 310 to NEW 312: Independent Study (does not count as NC seminar)**
**Variable Hours**

Go to http://ncis.as.ua.edu for more information and schedule an appointment with John Miller (mille031@ua.edu) to discuss particulars. Be sure to download and read instructions.

**NEW 339-001: New College Review II (does not count as NC seminar)**
**Amy Pirkle**
**W 3:00pm - 4:50pm, LY 215**
**2 Hours**

This workshop provides students with practical experience in writing and publishing a special interest publication, the *New College Review*. Students gain experience in thematic approaches to publication, conceptual formation for an audience, socially responsible publishing, and writing and editing persuasive essays. Students are strongly encouraged to take both NEW 338 and NEW 339 in sequence.